

方面强调利益集团之多、阻挠改革力量之强 VS 一方面强调 USPS 实施现代化极其必要、刻不容缓”，暗示下文将会出现新情形。

• 真题精解 •



37. According to Paragraph 2, the USPS fails to modernize itself due to ____.	37. 根据第二段,USPS 未能实现现代化是由于_____。
[A] the interference from interest groups	[A] 利益集团的干涉
[B] the inadequate funding from Congress	[B] 国会提供资金不足
[C] the shrinking demand for postal service	[C] 邮政服务需求萎缩
[D] the incompetence of postal unions	[D] 邮政工会的无能

[精准定位] 第二段指出,由于各利益集团向国会施压、要求保护现状,近年来立法改革频频失败,导致邮政局无力偿还债务、唯有推迟现代化。可见[A]正确。

[命题解密] 正确项[A]是对第二段因果链的合理概括。

[B]将第二段信息 Congress,the Postal Service unable to pay its bills 杂糅,主观推断出“国会援助资金不足”,但文章并未提及“国会资金援助”。[C]将首段⑤句 decreased demand for its... product 以及第二段②句 whatever else happens to the Postal Service 关联,主观得出“邮政服务需求减少导致 USPS 未能进行现代化”,但这只是在退步说明“无论邮政服务境况如何(利益集团都要求保护与其利益相关的现状)”,并未触及第二段所示真正原因。[D]与第二段因果逻辑“邮政工会向国会施压→立法改革失败”中传递的“邮政工会极具影响力”之意完全相悖。

[技巧总结] 本题就“涉及多个主体之间复杂关系的段落”命制因果事实题。解题关键在于借助状语功能、逻辑关联词、指代关系等,理解各主体之间关系,明确因果关系网。注:“与文中事实相反”以及“虽为文中事实、但和主干不存在因果关系”的选项均排除。

具体来看,解题关键在于借助 This is why(this 指代①句)、leaving(引导结果状语)、A exert pressure on B(A 向 B 施压等)描绘多个主体“利益集团、国会、USPS 等”之间关系,明确其间因果关系,得出[A]正确。[D]与文中事实相反,[C]虽为文中事实但并非原因、[B]则捏造信息 funding,均排除。

III ① Now comes word that everyone involved — Democrats, Republicans, the Postal Service, the unions and the system’s heaviest users — has finally agreed on a plan to fix the system. ② Legislation is moving through the House that would save USPS an estimated \$ 28.6 billion over five years, which could help pay for new vehicles^①, among other survival measures. ③ Most of the money would come from a penny-per-letter permanent rate increase and from shifting postal retirees^② into Medicare. ④ The latter step would largely offset^③ the financial burden of annually pre-funding^④ retiree health care, thus addressing^⑤ a long-standing^⑥ complaint by the USPS and its unions.

现在有消息称,所涉各方——民主党、共和党、邮政局、各工会以及邮政系统的极重度用户——终于就一项“解决系统问题的方案”达成一致。法规正在众议院接受审议,该法规会在五年中使 USPS 节省约 286 亿美元,可帮助负担新运输工具以及其它使其得以存活措施。这笔资金中的大部分将来自于每封信 1 美分的永久性邮资费率上调,以及将邮政退休人员转入“联邦医保计划”。后一举措将大幅抵消每年预付退休人员医保造成的财政负担,并由此化解 USPS 及其工会长久以来的抱怨。